

**SUPERIOR COURT, STATE OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF SANTA CLARA**

**Department 13
Honorable Daniel T. Nishigaya**

J. Long, Courtroom Clerk
191 North First Street, San Jose, CA 95113
Telephone: 408-882-2240

DATE: October 22, 2025

TIME: 9:00 & 9:01 A.M.

**TO CONTEST A TENTATIVE RULING, YOU MUST CALL (408) 808-6856
BEFORE 4:00 P.M. ON THE DAY PRIOR TO THE HEARING.**

**You must also inform all other sides to the issue before 4:00 P.M. the day prior to the hearing
that you plan to contest the ruling. The Court will not hear argument, and the tentative ruling will be
adopted if these notifications are not made. (Cal. Rule of Court 3.1308(a)(1); Civil Local Rule 8.E.)**

LINE #	CASE #	CASE TITLE	RULING
LINE 4	25CV455540	Citibank N.A. vs Lucitinna Jimenez	Motion: Admissions Deemed Admitted Plaintiff's unopposed motion is GRANTED. "[T]he failure to file an opposition creates an inference that the motion ... is meritorious." (<i>Sexton v. Super Ct.</i> (1997) 58 Cal.App.4th 1403, 1410.). Those matters specified in Plaintiff's Request for Admissions are deemed admitted and/or documents deemed genuine. Plaintiff to prepare the final order within 10 days of the date of the hearing.
LINE 5	25CV460138	Christopher Cheung vs Rivian, LLC	Hearing: Petition Compel Arbitration Ctrl Click (or scroll down) on Line 5 for tentative ruling.
LINE 6	25CV460423	CITY OF SAN JOSE, a government entity et al vs James Eu et al	Hearing: Status re: Ex Parte Application Parties are to appear at 11:00 a.m. to discuss status and setting. Remote appearance by video is acceptable.
LINE 7	25CV466337	David Green vs Yelena Green et al	Motion to Dismiss Ctrl Click (or scroll down) on Line 7 for tentative ruling.
9:01 LINE 1	25CV472917	LAKIBA SARAN TAYLOR et al vs GREGORY FUNDING et al	Motion: Withdraw as attorney The motion is MOOT. A Request for Dismissal of the entire action was filed on 10/15/2025, and the case was dismissed without prejudice the same day.

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Calendar Line 5

Case Name: *Christopher Cheung vs Rivian, LLC*

Case No.: 25CV460138

"The party seeking arbitration bears the burden of proving the existence of an arbitration agreement, and the party opposing arbitration bears the burden of proving any defense[.]" (*Pinnacle Museum Tower Assn. v. Pinnacle Market Development (US), LLC* (2012) 55 Cal.4th 223, 236.)

Plaintiff contends the Purchase Agreement attached to Defendant's motion is inadmissible and that Defendant has not established that he agreed to it. These arguments are unpersuasive. Defendant has met its initial burden by attaching a copy of the arbitration agreement purporting to bear Plaintiff's signature. (See *Gamboa v. Northeast Community Clinic* (2021) 72 Cal.App.5th 158, 165.) Although Defendant need not follow the normal procedures of document authentication (*Condee v. Longwood Management Corp.* (2001) 88 Cal.App.4th 215, 219), the Court believes Defendant's evidence is more than sufficient to establish authentication.¹ In response Plaintiff does not provide a declaration or any other evidence to suggest he did not enter into the Purchase Agreement. Indeed, as Defendant points out, Plaintiff would be hard pressed to do so when he is bringing suit as the purchaser of the vehicle.

Plaintiff's additional arguments also lack merit. Defendant is not attempting to enforce an arbitration agreement contained within a warranty agreement. The Arbitration Agreement here is contained in the Purchase Agreement that Plaintiff entered into when he purchased the vehicle. In addition, none of Plaintiff's claims arises under the Magnuson-Moss Warranty Act ("MMWA"). Accordingly, Plaintiff's reliance on the MMWA is misplaced. So too is Plaintiff's argument that the Federal Arbitration Act "simply does not apply in state court." (Opposition, at p. 7.) "[T]he parties may ... voluntarily elect to have the FAA govern enforcement of the Agreement, as they did here." (*Victrola 89, LLC v. Jaman Properties 8 LLC* (2020) 46 Cal.App.5th 337, 355.)

Lastly, Plaintiff's resort to Code of Civil Procedure § 1281.2 is of no avail. Rather than joining in Defendant's motion or conceding, Plaintiff's opposition, and indeed his filing of the instant action, clearly shows his refusal to arbitrate.

The motion is GRANTED and the case is STAYED under Code of Civil Procedure section 1281.4. The court VACATES the case management conference that is currently scheduled for November 13, 2025 and instead sets this matter for a case status review regarding arbitration on **April 24, 2026 at 10:00 a.m.** in Department 13.

Defendant to prepare the final order within 10 days of the date of the hearing.

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¹ Plaintiff's evidentiary objections are overruled.